

SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE

Large Ship Repair Services — Naval Station Rota, Spain

THIS IS NOT A SOLICITATION. NO CONTRACT WILL BE AWARDED FROM THIS NOTICE.

Notice Type	Sources Sought / Market Research
Solicitation Number	N6817126RT003
Issuing Office	Naval Supply Systems Command (NAVSUP) Fleet Logistics Center Sigonella Detachment Rota, Spain
Contracting Activity	Forward Deployed Maintenance Center (FDRMC) Rota/ NAVSUP FLC Sigonella Rota
NAICS Code	336611 — Ship Building and Repairing
PSC Code	J998 — Maint/Repair/Rebuild of Ships, Small Craft, Pontoons & Floating Docks
Set-Aside	None Anticipated at This Time (FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION)
Place of Performance	Naval Station Rota, Cádiz Province, Spain and/or Alternate Sites as Proposed
Response Due Date	6 April 2026
Response Due Time	2:00 PM Central European Time (CET)
Submit Responses To	nelson.j.arias.civ@us.navy.mil
Point of Contact	Nelson Arias, Contracting Officer Name, +34 956 821 652
SAM.gov Listing	www.sam.gov — Opportunities; set solicitation number above as filter keyword

SECTION 1 — PURPOSE AND BACKGROUND

1.1 Purpose of This Notice

The Naval Supply Systems Command (NAVSUP) Fleet Logistics Center (FLC) Sigonella, acting on behalf of Naval Sea Systems Command's (NAVSEA) Forward Deployed Regional Maintenance Center (FDRMC) at Naval Station (NAVSTA) Rota, Spain, is conducting market research to identify qualified sources capable of providing large ship repair, maintenance, overhaul, and related services for U.S. Navy vessels operating in the European and African theater.

This Sources Sought Notice (SSN) is issued solely for market research and planning purposes in accordance with FAR 10.001 and FAR 15.201(e). It does not constitute a solicitation, a promise to issue a solicitation, or a commitment by the U.S. Government. No contract will be awarded as a direct result of this notice. Responses will not be used as proposals, and no evaluation will be conducted to determine competitive range or make a contract award based on responses received.

The Government seeks to determine the interest, capability, and capacity of qualified companies — including Spanish domestic firms, U.S. firms with overseas operating capability, and international defense shipbuilders — to perform large ship repair and maintenance availability services at or near Naval Station Rota, Spain.

1.2 Background and Operational Context

Naval Station Rota is Spanish military installation located in Rota, Province of Cádiz, Spain, on the southwestern coast of the Iberian Peninsula at the entrance to the Strait of Gibraltar. It is the largest U.S. Navy installation in Europe and serves as the critical logistics and maintenance hub for U.S. Naval Forces Europe-Africa (NAVEUR-NAVAF) and U.S. Sixth Fleet.

The installation currently homeports five (5) Arleigh Burke-class (DDG-51 Flight IIA) guided missile destroyers assigned to support NATO's Integrated Air and Missile Defense (IAMD) architecture with a sixth vessel planned. These vessels require, but may not be limited to Chief of Naval Operations (CNO) Selected Restricted Availabilities (SRAs), Surface Incremental Availabilities (SIAs), along with Continuous Maintenance Availabilities (CMAVs), Voyage Maintenance Availabilities (VMAVs), Window of Opportunity Availabilities (WOOs), Emergent Maintenance (EM), which may include dry-docking requirements.

Additional U.S. Navy surface combatants, Military Sealift Command (MSC) vessels, amphibious ships, and NATO allied vessels routinely transit and utilize NAVSTA Rota's port facilities throughout the year, generating additional episodic repair and maintenance requirements outside of this contract vehicle.

1.3 Description of Services Required

The Government anticipates a requirement for the following categories of ship repair and maintenance services. The below description is for market research purposes only and does not define the final requirement:

- Hull, Mechanical, and Electrical (HM&E) Repairs — Structural, propulsion, mechanical systems, piping, valves, pumps, heat exchangers, and associated hull-related repairs on DDG-51 class destroyers and other surface combatants.
- Combat Systems and Electronic Systems Maintenance — Maintenance, repair, and installation of combat management systems, radar, sonar, communications, and electronic warfare systems; integration of Alteration Installation Team (AIT) packages as directed by NAVSEA.
- Dry-docking Services and Facilities — Haul-out and dry-docking support including hull cleaning, painting, hull inspections, underwater hull work, shaft and propeller maintenance, and sea chest/sea valve work.
- SIAs — Typically a 80 to 100 day availability that comprises part of the Navy optimized fleet response plan maintenance cycle, designed to address critical depot-level casualty reports, system installations, and modernization work between major availability periods.
- SRAs — Typically a 100 to 140 day period, designed for labor-intensive accomplishment of depot-level, selected alterations, and modernization work.
- CMAVs — Scheduled in-port maintenance periods of varying durations covering multiple systems and work packages simultaneously.
- WOOs and EMs — Unscheduled availabilities that are often executed with limited advanced notification (i.e. less than 24 hours advance notice).
- Voyage Repair — Emergent, corrective repairs performed on vessels in transit or during brief port calls, potentially requiring 24/7 rapid mobilization.

- Ordnance Alterations (ORDALTs) and Temporary Alterations (TEMPALTs) — Installation and removal of weapons system alterations and temporary equipment modifications per NAVSEA technical guidance.
- Maintenance Assist Teams (MATs) / Alteration Installation Teams (AITs) — Hosting and supporting Government-furnished technical teams performing specialized system work alongside contractor personnel.
- Industrial Hygiene, Environmental Compliance, and Waste Management — Compliance with Spanish environmental regulations, Agreement on Defense Cooperation (ADC) between the U.S. and Spain, and applicable U.S. Navy environmental directives for all shipyard operations.

SECTION 2 — INSTRUCTIONS TO RESPONDENTS

2.1 Response Format and Submission

Interested parties are requested to submit a written response (white paper / capability statement) addressing the questions set forth in Section 3 of this notice. Responses should be submitted electronically in Adobe PDF or Microsoft Word (.docx) format to the Point of Contact identified above.

Responses shall be no longer than TWENTY-FIVE (25) pages in length (excluding cover page, table of contents, and appendices), using a minimum 11-point font and 1-inch margins. Detailed technical data, brochures, or past performance documentation may be included as appendices and will not count against the page limit.

The U.S. Government will not reimburse respondents for any costs associated with preparing and submitting a response to this notice.

2.2 Organization of Responses

Respondents are strongly encouraged to organize their capability statement response to directly mirror the question structure in Section 3, addressing each question individually and in order. Clearly label each response section with the corresponding question number and topic heading. Failure to address specific questions may limit the utility of the response for market research purposes.

2.3 Proprietary Information

If a response contains proprietary or business-sensitive information, the respondent should clearly mark such information on each page with the notation: PROPRIETARY / BUSINESS SENSITIVE. The Government will protect such information to the extent permitted by law. Respondents are advised not to include classified information in responses to this Sources Sought Notice; this is an unclassified market research action.

2.4 Foreign Firms and Non-U.S. Entities

Responses from non-U.S. companies, European defense firms, and international shipbuilders are encouraged. Such respondents should address their familiarity with U.S. Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) and its supplements, relevant equivalency certifications, and any prior experience working under U.S. Government contracts or sub-contracts. Firms should also address their capability to meet relevant security requirements, including vetting of personnel accessing

Spanish installations, U.S. Navy facilities and vessels, and their capability to carry out these activities in Spain, under Spanish law

SECTION 3 — QUESTIONS FOR RESPONDENTS

Please respond to ALL questions below. The Government uses responses to assess market viability, identify potential sources, inform acquisition strategy, and determine whether to pursue competitive or sole-source procurement. Responses to individual questions may be as brief as a single paragraph or as detailed as necessary; the Government values specificity, candor, and honesty over volume.

PART A — COMPANY INFORMATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

1	Identity	Provide your company's full legal name, business address (including registered country), CAGE Code or NCAGE Code (if registered), DUNS/UEI number (if applicable), and System for Award Management (SAM.gov) registration status. Indicate whether your firm is a large business, small business (by NAICS 336611 size standard), foreign-owned entity, or joint venture. <i>(Guidance: NCAGE codes apply to non-U.S. entities; SAM.gov registration is required for U.S. federal prime contracts but not for market research responses.)</i>
2	Business Type	Describe the legal structure and ownership of your company. Is your firm publicly traded, privately held, or government-owned (e.g., state-owned enterprise)? If foreign-owned, provide the country of ownership and any relevant restrictions on working with the U.S. Government, NATO, or on U.S. military installations under your nation's export control regime.
3	Points of Contact	Provide the name, title, phone number, and email address for the primary point of contact for this response, as well as any business development or contracts personnel the Government may contact for follow-on inquiries.
4	Technical Certifications	List all relevant certifications, qualifications, and accreditations currently held by your organization, including but not limited to: Master Ship Repair Agreements (MSRA) or Agreement for Boat Repair (ABR); Dry-dock certifications; Navy approved contractor qualifications; American Bureau of Shipping (ABS) certification; DNV, Lloyd's Register, or equivalent classification society approvals; ISO 9001:2015 or equivalent quality management system; SUBSAFE certification (if applicable); and any NATO or allied nation defense ministry approvals.

5	Past Performance — U.S. Navy	Describe your firm's prior experience performing ship repair, maintenance, or overhaul work for the U.S. Navy, U.S. Coast Guard, or Military Sealift Command. For each relevant contract, provide the following: name of contracting activity, contract number (if not restricted), vessel class(es), type of work performed, contract value and period of performance, and Government Point of Contact (name, phone, email) for reference. Clearly identify which of these contracts were performed in which particular country. <i>(Guidance: Past performance on DDG-51, CG-47, FFG, LHD, or LPD class vessels is of particular relevance.)</i>
6	Past Performance — Foreign/Allied Navies	Describe any prior experience performing ship maintenance or repair for allied or foreign navies (NATO members preferred). Include the name of the naval customer, the nature of work performed, the country of performance, and any relevant points of contact. This information will help the Government assess your familiarity with operating in multinational military environments.
7	Workforce Size and Trades	Provide the approximate total number of direct employees in your ship repair workforce, broken down by primary trade (e.g., shipfitters, welders, machinists, electricians, pipefitters, electronics technicians, painters/blasters). Identify how many of these employees currently hold U.S. Navy or NAVSEA certifications, and how many are citizens of EU/NATO member nations.

PART B — CAPABILITY TO PERFORM AT NAVAL STATION ROTA, SPAIN

8	Physical Presence	Does your company currently have a physical operational presence (office, facility, yard, warehouse, or equipment cache) within 100 kilometers of Naval Station Rota, Spain? If yes, describe the location, facility size, capabilities resident at that location, and the number of personnel presently assigned. If no, describe in detail how you would establish such a presence if required under a future contract. <i>(Guidance: Respondents who do not currently have a Rota-area presence but could establish one after contract award are still encouraged to respond.)</i>
9	Dry-docking Capability	Describe the dry-docking infrastructure available to support work on DDG-51 class destroyers [approximate 9,500 long ton (LT) displacement; 509 ft. (155.3 meter) length overall (LOA); 66.9 ft. (20.39 meter) beam; 20.6 (6.28 meter) ft. draft]. Identify all dry-docking facilities within 200 nautical miles of Rota that your firm owns, leases, or has a confirmed access agreement with, including: facility name, location, dock type (graving dock, floating dry-dock, syncrolift), rated capacity (LT), and current availability. If your firm does not have dry-dock access, explain how you would satisfy dry-docking requirements.

		<i>(Guidance: The closest relevant dry-docking facilities include: Navantia Cádiz, Navantia Ferrol, and private commercial yards in the Bay of Cádiz.)</i>
10	Rapid Mobilization	Describe your firm's capability to mobilize a repair team to Naval Station Rota on an emergent basis — for example, within 24, 48, or 72 hours of notification. How many skilled tradespeople could you deploy in this timeframe? What pre-positioned equipment, tooling, and materials would be available? Have you previously responded to an emergent or unscheduled availability in a foreign port? Describe the circumstances.
11	Multi-Ship Capacity	If required to support concurrent maintenance availabilities on multiple vessels simultaneously (e.g., two or more DDGs in different stages of availability), describe your workforce capacity, management approach, and any subcontracting or teaming arrangements that would allow you to meet this requirement. What is your maximum concurrent ship capacity at Rota?
12	Combat Systems	Describe your capability to perform maintenance and repair on U.S. Navy combat systems, including but not limited to: AN/SPY-1D(V) AEGIS radar systems, Mk 41 Vertical Launch Systems, Mk 45 5-inch gun systems, AN/SQS-53C hull-mounted sonar, and associated C4I equipment. Do you have any U.S. Government approvals or a current Agreement for Boat Repair (ABR) authorizing work on a particular system? Do your personnel hold the required clearances (Secret or higher) to work on these systems?
13	Security Clearances	Describe your organization's capability to obtain and maintain U.S. security clearances for personnel who will need access to U.S. classified systems, spaces, and information aboard U.S. Navy vessels. How many of your current employees already hold active U.S. security clearances at the Secret level or above? Describe your facility security status (FCL) if applicable. For non-U.S. firms, address your familiarity with and ability to comply with the DoD Industrial Security Program, the National Industrial Security Program (NISP), and applicable ADC/Status of Forces Agreement (SOFA) provisions governing contractor access to U.S. military installations in Spain.
14	Spanish Regulatory Compliance	Describe your experience operating under Spanish labor law, environmental regulations, and port authority requirements. Are you familiar with the requirements of the U.S.-Spain Bilateral Defense Agreement and the ADC as they relate to contractor operations on the Rota base? Can you obtain the necessary permits from Spanish authorities (Ministerio de Defensa, Port Authority of Cádiz, local environmental agencies) to conduct industrial shipyard operations on or adjacent to the base? Do you have experience navigating the

		Spanish industrial relations environment, including dealing with trade unions (e.g., CCOO, UGT) in a shipyard context?
15	Local Subcontracting	Describe your strategy for utilizing local Spanish subcontractors, vendors, and specialized trade firms to supplement your own workforce and supply chain. Identify any Spanish companies you currently have teaming agreements or subcontract relationships with that would support this effort.

PART C — TEAMING, JOINT VENTURES, AND ALTERNATIVE APPROACHES

16	Teaming Arrangements	Is your company currently a party to, or actively pursuing, a teaming arrangement or joint venture with another company that would increase your capability to compete for this requirement? If so, describe the nature of the arrangement, the identities of proposed team members, the respective roles and responsibilities, and the geographic distribution of work. Would the joint venture or teaming arrangement be structured as a formal legal entity or an informal mentor-protégé / prime-sub relationship?
17	Alternative Performance Locations	If your firm is unable or unwilling to perform the full scope of work at Naval Station Rota itself, describe any alternative locations or concepts of operations you would propose to support the U.S. Navy's ship maintenance mission. For example: a nearby commercial shipyard in the European theatre area used as a primary work site with a liaison office on base; dry-docking at a supporting facility ; or a hub-and-spoke model using Rota as the port of embarkation with a regional repair yard. Describe the travel/tow time, feasibility, and risk of each proposed alternative. <i>(Guidance: The Government will consider all reasonable alternatives that maintain effective support to homeported DDGs without significantly extending downtime.)</i>
18	Phased Entry Strategy	If your firm does not currently have a Rota-area presence, describe a realistic phased plan to establish one. Include: Phase 1 — Initial mobilization (personnel, equipment, licensing, and basing); Phase 2 — Initial operating capability (able to perform routine CMAVs); Phase 3 — Full operating capability (able to perform single availabilities and concurrent multi-ship availabilities). Provide estimated timelines and resource requirements for each phase. Provide two descriptions where the Government may provide may provide space and another where the Contractor provides their own space.

PART D — BARRIERS, CHALLENGES, AND RISK IDENTIFICATION

The Government specifically requests candid and detailed responses to the questions in this section. Honest identification of potential barriers and challenges — including those that might prevent your firm from bidding or performing — is essential market research data. Responses identifying barriers will not be viewed negatively; they help the Government structure the acquisition to maximize competition.

19	Regulatory & Legal Barriers	Identify any legal, regulatory, or policy barriers that would prevent or significantly complicate your firm's ability to bid on or perform this contract. This includes: restrictions in your home country's arms export regulations (e.g., ITAR applicability for non-U.S. firms); restrictions related to your ownership structure (e.g., FOCI — Foreign Ownership, Control, or Influence — mitigation requirements); Spanish foreign worker permit and visa requirements; EU Public Procurement Directive limitations; and any conflict-of-interest concerns arising from existing Government contracts.
20	Workforce & Labor Barriers	Describe any workforce or labor-related barriers to performance at Rota. This includes: difficulty obtaining skilled U.S. Navy-certified tradespeople willing to relocate to or deploy to southern Spain; Spanish work permit and NIE (Foreigner Identification Number) requirements for non-EU employees; Spanish collective bargaining agreements that may affect subcontracting flexibility; bilingual workforce requirements (Spanish/English); and challenges maintaining a certified workforce when personnel rotate.
21	Facility & Infrastructure Barriers	Identify infrastructure constraints that could limit performance. This includes: absence of a dry-dock or one within a reasonable distance to Rota; limitations of the existing pier infrastructure for industrial work; restrictions on storing hazardous materials (paint, solvents, gasses) on a Spanish military installation; power, water, and compressed air utilities availability for industrial operations; and access road limitations for delivering heavy equipment and large components to the worksite.
22	Supply Chain & Logistics Barriers	Describe supply chain challenges associated with performing in Spain. This includes: lead times for Contractor-Furnished Equipment (CFE) or Material (CFM) components shipped from Continental United States (CONUS); availability of DDG-51 class-specific spare parts in Europe; customs clearance and importation procedures for controlled or dual-use goods entering Spain under the U.S.-Spain bilateral defense agreement; and the cost and complexity of warehousing strategic repair materials in the Cádiz area.
23	Security & Access Barriers	Identify security-related barriers to operating on a Spanish naval installation. This includes: vetting requirements for non-U.S. citizen workers requiring base access; certification requirements for contractor personnel working on classified combat systems; encryption and classified information handling requirements when working in or near

		ship spaces containing classified material; and challenges obtaining and maintaining DoD contractor Common Access Cards (CACs) for foreign national employees.
24	Financial & Business Case Barriers	Describe any financial or business case barriers that would prevent your firm from pursuing this opportunity. This includes: insufficient contract ceiling or scope to justify the capital investment required to establish a Rota presence; currency exchange risk (USD vs. EUR) and contract pricing in a foreign currency environment; bonding and performance guarantee requirements; competition from a deeply established incumbent; difficulty finding viable domestic (Spanish) subcontractors with U.S. Navy familiarity; and the cost of obtaining and maintaining relevant U.S. certifications.
25	Host Nation Barriers	Describe any barriers arising from Spanish or EU host-nation law or politics. This includes: Spanish shipyard labor laws and union requirements that affect workforce flexibility; environmental permitting delays for industrial operations; restrictions imposed by the Spanish Ministry of Defense on foreign (non-Spanish) defense companies performing work on Spanish national territory; restrictions on U.S. military-to-contractor information transfers on Spanish soil; and any concerns about political or public opposition to expanded U.S. military industrial activity in the Rota area.
26	ITAR / Export Control Barriers	Specifically address International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) and Export Administration Regulations (EAR) as they apply to your firm's proposed operations. If your firm is non-U.S., describe: how you currently manage ITAR-controlled technical data received from U.S. Navy customers; whether your firm holds a Technical Assistance Agreement (TAA) or Manufacturing License Agreement (MLA) with the U.S. State Department; and how you would handle controlled unclassified information (CUI) and ship-specific technical manuals, drawings, and specifications.

PART E — ACQUISITION STRATEGY FEEDBACK

27	Contract Type Preference	From your firm's perspective, what contract type would best support the performance of ship repair at an overseas location such as Rota? Options to consider: Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP); Cost-Plus-Fixed-Fee (CPFF); Cost-Plus-Award-Fee (CPAF); Indefinite-Delivery Indefinite-Quantity (IDIQ) with FFP task orders; or a hybrid approach. Explain the rationale for your preference, including which cost elements (i.e. labor, materials, ODCs) are most difficult to estimate in advance at this location.
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28	Contract Duration	What contract base period and option period structure do you recommend to enable a new contractor to make the capital investment required to establish an effective Rota presence?
29	Performance Standards	What performance metrics and standards do you believe are most appropriate for measuring contractor performance on a ship repair contract at an overseas location? Specifically, address: schedule adherence (on-time completion of availabilities); quality of repairs (rework rates); safety (Occupational Safety and Health Administration, OSHA-equivalent incident rate); readiness restoration (operational availability of repaired vessel systems); and customer satisfaction.
30	Government-Furnished Resources	Identify what Government-Furnished Property (GFP), Government-Furnished Equipment (GFE), Government-Furnished Material (GFM), facilities, or services would be essential to your firm's successful performance. Examples might include: pier-side utilities and services on the Rota installation; access to government-owned tooling or test equipment; a government-provided lay-down area or warehouse space; Government-Furnished Information (GFI) such as ship drawings, maintenance records, and technical manuals; and Government-provided security support for classified work.
31	Recommendations to Government	Provide any additional recommendations, observations, or market intelligence that you believe would help the Government structure the most effective and competitive acquisition for ship repair services at NAVSTA Rota. This is an open-ended question — the Government values candid input from industry on how to achieve the best value acquisition outcome, maximize competition, and support the long-term maintenance readiness of forward-deployed naval forces.

SECTION 4 — GENERAL INFORMATION

4.1 No Commitment

This Sources Sought Notice does not commit the Government to issue a solicitation, make an award, or pay any costs incurred in the preparation and submission of information in response to this notice. The Government does not intend to hold discussions or provide written feedback to individual respondents regarding their submissions.

4.2 Use of Responses

All responses received will be used solely for market research and acquisition planning purposes. The Government may contact respondents to clarify or expand on responses. Responses will not be returned and may be retained by the Government in accordance with applicable records management requirements.

4.3 Applicable Regulations and References

- FAR Part 10 — Market Research
- FAR Part 15.201(e) — Exchanges with Industry Before Receipt of Proposals
- DFARS Subpart 225.7 — Prohibited Sources; Acquisition from Foreign Sources
- NMCARS 5225.802-90 — Procedures for acquisitions that can be satisfied only by sources outside the United States
- 10 U.S.C. § 8680 — Contracts for Repair and Maintenance of Naval Vessels in Foreign Shipyards
- U.S.-Spain Agreement on Defense Cooperation (ADC), as amended
- NATO Status of Forces Agreement (SOFA), London 1951 (19 U.S.T. 3169)

4.4 Questions Regarding This Notice

Questions about this Sources Sought Notice may be submitted in writing to the Contracting Officer identified above. Questions and responses of general interest will be posted to SAM.gov. Questions submitted fewer than seven (7) calendar days before the response deadline may not receive an answer before the due date.

— END OF SOURCES SOUGHT NOTICE —

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United States, Dept. of War. "225.7 Prohibited Sources," 10 November 2025, Defense Acquisition Regulations, https://www.acquisition.gov/dfars/part-225-foreign-acquisition#DFARS_SUBPART_225.7.

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